Bible Syllabus — High School

2026–2027

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

Instructor	Email	Room Location & Hours
Kirsten Decker	Kirsten@rivertech.me	Dance Hall — Fridays, 1:00-1:40 PM

GENERAL INFORMATION

Description

This course walks 9th–12th graders through Scripture using different reflection methods each quarter: Lectio Divina/One Word, S.O.A.P. Devotional, Character Study/POV Rewrites of major biblical figures, and a Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth study that pushes back against cultural lies with Scripture. The goal is to build a mature, personal habit of engaging with the Bible through different devotionals.

Expectations and Goals

Students are expected to bring their Bible and journal to class each week, complete that week's reflection using the assigned method, and participate in class discussion. By the end of the year, students should be able to apply four different methods of Scripture engagement, write from another person's perspective with empathy and insight, and articulate how Scripture speaks against cultural lies.

COURSE MATERIALS

Required Materials

- A Bible (any translation)
- A journal or notebook dedicated to weekly reflections
- A pen or pencil

Optional Materials

- Colored pens or highlighters for journaling

Required Text

The Bible — translation of the student/family's choice

COURSE SCHEDULE

Quarter 1 (Sept.–Oct.): Lectio Divina / One Word

Week	Topic	Reading / Resources
1 — Sept. 4	Orientation Week	N/A
2 — Sept. 11	Fruit of the Spirit	Lectio Divina / One Word: Galatians 5:22–23
3 — Sept. 18	Living sacrifices	Lectio Divina / One Word: Romans 12:1–2
4 — Sept. 25	The Lord's prayer	Lectio Divina / One Word: Matthew 6:9-13
5 — Oct. 2	The Holy Spirit comes	Lectio Divina / One Word: Acts 2:1–13
6 — Oct. 9	God's perfect advice	Lectio Divina / One Word: Proverbs 4:4–23
7 — Oct. 16	Psalm of David	Lectio Divina / One Word: Psalm 27
8 — Oct. 23	Living as Light	Lectio Divina / One Word: Ephesians 4:12-5:2
9 — Oct. 30	Write your own psalm	N/A

Quarter 2 (Nov.–Jan.): S.O.A.P.

Week	Topic	Reading / Resources
1 — Nov. 6	Creation	S.O.A.P.: Genesis 1–2:4
2 — Nov. 13	The Fall	S.O.A.P.: Genesis 3:1–19
3 — Nov. 20	Manna in the wilderness	S.O.A.P.: Exodus 16:1–31
4 — Dec. 4	The battle of Jericho	S.O.A.P.: Joshua 6
5 — Dec. 11	Elijah and the prophets of Baal	S.O.A.P.: 1 Kings 18
6 — Dec. 18	Feeding the five thousand / stepping onto the water	S.O.A.P.: Matthew 14
7 — Jan. 8	Doubting Thomas	S.O.A.P.: John 20:24–29
8 — Jan. 15	N/A	S.O.A.P. Journals Due, Independent S.O.A.P. Entry

Quarter 3 (Jan.–Apr.): Character Study / POV Rewrite

Week	Topic	Reading / Resources
1 — Jan. 22	The story of Joseph	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Joseph, Genesis 37–45
2 — Jan. 29	Moses and the burning bush	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Moses, Exodus 3
3 — Feb. 5	The story of Esther	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Esther, Esther
4 — Feb. 12	David and Goliath	Character Study / POV Rewrite: David, 1 Samuel 17
5 — Feb. 26	Jonah runs from God	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Jonah
6 — Mar. 5	Mary is called; Jesus in the garden	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Jesus or Mary, Luke 1:26–56; Matthew 26:36–46
7 — Mar. 12	Peter denies Jesus; Peter is restored	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Peter, Matthew 26:69–75; John 21:15–19
8 — Mar. 19	Road to Damascus	Character Study / POV Rewrite: Paul, Acts 9
9 — Mar. 26	Character study project work day	Work day

Quarter 4 (Apr.–May): Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth

Week	Topic	Reading / Resources
1 — Apr. 9	Fully known by God	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Psalm 139
2 — Apr. 16	The Lord is my shepherd	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Psalm 23
3 — Apr. 23	Contentment and peace	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Philippians 4:1-20
4 — Apr. 30	The fiery furnace	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Daniel 3
5 — May 7	God's love	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Romans 8:18–38
6 — May 14	The vine and the branches	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: John 15
7 — May 21	Faith	Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth: Hebrews 12
8 — May 28	Reflection essay	Work day

ASSIGNMENT SCHEDULE

Date	Subject
Oct. 30	In-class original psalm writing activity, Journal entries due
Jan. 15	S.O.A.P. journal entries due, Independent Entry
Mar. 26	Character study project due, Journal Entries Due
May 28	Reflection essay due, Final Journal Entries Due

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION AND RESOURCES

Weekly Reflection Methods

Each quarter uses a different method for weekly Scripture reflection.

Lectio Divina / One Word (Q1): read the passage, then land on just one word that captures it. Write that word big, then write 3–4 sentences on why and how I live out that one word today.

S.O.A.P. (Q2): Scripture — a verse that stood out; Observation —What did I notice about this verse; Application — one way it connects to their life this week; Prayer — a short response to God based on what they wrote.

Character Study / POV Rewrite (Q3): pick a person in the passage, rewrite the scene in first person from that character's perspective, and end with: what would this person want me to know?

Biggest Lie / Biggest Truth (Q4): What's a lie our culture (or the student's own head) tells that this passage pushes back against? What's the truth the passage offers instead? Close with a short prayer: God, help me live out the truth instead of the lie.

Grading & Communication

Students are assessed on weekly participation and reflections. Participation in class discussions is also considered in the participation grade.